

Too few, too many, or just right? Optimizing sample sizes for population-level inferences in animal tracking projects

Inês Silva^{1,*}, Christen H. Fleming^{2,3}, Michael J. Noonan⁴, William F. Fagan², Justin M. Calabrese^{1,3,5,6}

¹Center for Advanced Systems Understanding (CASUS), Helmholtz-Zentrum Dresden-Rossendorf (HZDR), Görlitz, Germany;

²Department of Biology, University of Maryland, College Park, Maryland, USA; ³Smithsonian National Zoo and Conservation

Biology Institute, Virginia, USA; ⁴Department of Biology, University of British Columbia Okanagan, British Columbia,

Canada; ⁵Helmholtz Centre for Environmental Research – UFZ, Leipzig, Germany; ⁶Technische Universität Dresden (TUD),

Dresden, Germany

*Corresponding author: Inês Silva, E-mail: i.simo-es-silva@hzdr.de, imss.silva@gmail.com

S4. Leave-one out approach

Home range estimation

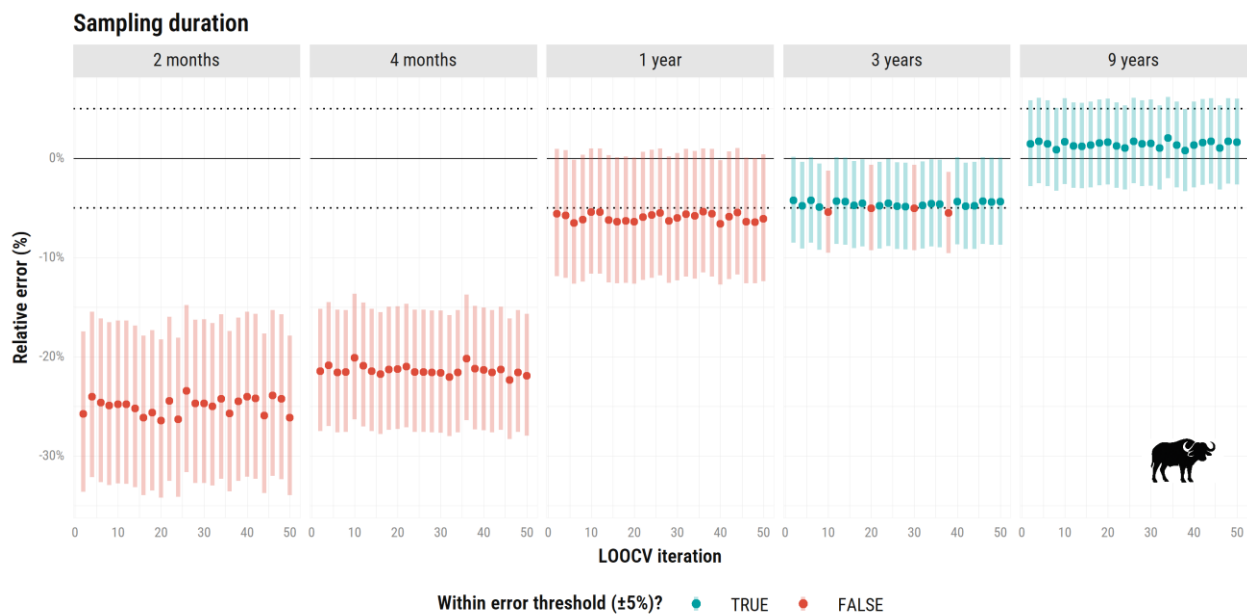


Figure S4.1. Relative error (%) in home range area estimates across different sampling durations for simulated African buffalos (*Syncerus caffer*) for a leave-one-out approach. Points represent the mean relative error (%) for one of 50 iterations (excluding a different individual each time), with its 95% confidence intervals. Horizontal dotted lines indicate the $\pm 5\%$ error threshold. Blue points fall within this threshold; red points fall outside of it.



Figure S4.2. Relative error (%) in home range area estimates across different sampling durations for simulated Mongolian gazelles (*Procapra gutturosa*) for a leave-one-out approach. Points represent the mean relative error (%) for one of 50 iterations (excluding a different individual each time), with its 95% confidence intervals. Horizontal dotted lines indicate the $\pm 5\%$ error threshold. Blue points fall within this threshold; red points fall outside of it.

Speed & distance estimation

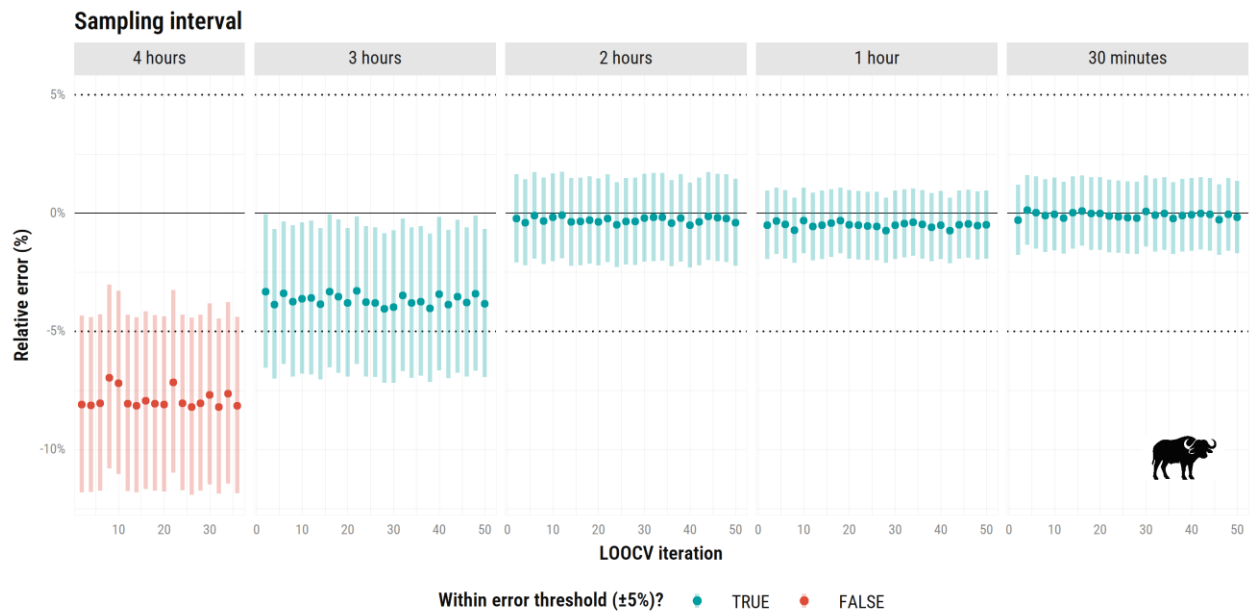


Figure S4.3. Relative error (%) in speed & distance estimates across different sampling intervals for simulated African buffalos (*Syncerus caffer*) for a leave-one-out approach. Points represent the mean relative error (%) for one of 50 iterations (excluding a different individual each time), with its 95% confidence intervals. Horizontal dotted lines indicate the $\pm 5\%$ error threshold. Blue points fall within this threshold; red points fall outside of it.



Figure S4.4. Relative error (%) in speed & distance estimates across different sampling intervals for simulated Mongolian gazelles (*Procapra gutturosa*) for a leave-one-out approach. Points represent the mean relative error (%) for one of 50 iterations (excluding a different individual each time), with its 95% confidence intervals. Horizontal dotted lines indicate the $\pm 5\%$ error threshold. Blue points fall within this threshold; red points fall outside of it.